SPIRITUAL/RELIGIOUS FALSE BELIEF #63 · HEAVEN

“Heaven will be an endless, boring church service.”

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Where it often comes from

Pictures of heaven as clouds, harps, and endless singing. Long, dull church services in childhood. Never hearing much about what heaven is really like. Thinking of eternity as time dragging on forever. Loving life on earth and fearing heaven will be less.

What Scripture teaches

Scripture describes heaven as far richer than we can imagine: no eye has seen what God has prepared for those who love Him. In God’s presence is fullness of joy and eternal pleasures. God promises a new heaven and a new earth, a holy city, a great banquet, and His people reigning with Him. Worship there will not be dull duty but the joy of seeing God’s face. Everything good on earth is only a shadow of what is coming.

> *“Rather, as it is written: ‘No eye has seen, no ear has heard, no heart has imagined, what God has prepared for those who love Him.’”* **(1 Corinthians 2:9)**.

Also see

> “You have made known to me the path of life; You will fill me with joy in Your presence, with eternal pleasures at Your right hand” **(Psalm 16:11)**.

> “Then I saw a new heaven and a new earth, for the first heaven and earth had passed away, and the sea was no more. I saw the holy city, the new Jerusalem, coming down out of heaven from God, prepared as a bride adorned for her husband. And I heard a loud voice from the throne saying: ‘Behold, the dwelling place of God is with man, and He will dwell with them. They will be His people, and God Himself will be with them as their God.’” **(Revelation 21:1–3)**.

> “I say to you that many will come from the east and the west to share the banquet with Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob in the kingdom of heaven” **(Matthew 8:11)**.

> “No longer will there be any curse. The throne of God and of the Lamb will be within the city, and His servants will worship Him. They will see His face, and His name will be on their foreheads. There will be no more night in the city, and they will have no need for the light of a lamp or of the sun. For the Lord God will shine on them, and they will reign forever and ever” **(Revelation 22:3–5)**.

Common self-statements

- Heaven sounds boring.
- I’d rather stay on earth.
- Forever singing hymns? No thanks.
- I’ll miss all the good things here.
- Eternity will feel like it never ends, in a bad way.
- I feel guilty that heaven doesn’t excite me.

Common logical errors

- **Limited imagination:** Picturing heaven only through dull childhood images.
- **Projection:** Assuming heaven will feel like the most boring parts of church.

- **Mental filter:** Overlooking Scripture's pictures of feasting, beauty, and joy.
- **Fortune telling:** Predicting you will be bored without knowing what God has prepared.

Challenging questions

- What does 1 Corinthians 2:9 say about what God has prepared?
- What does Psalm 16:11 say is in God's presence?
- What images does Scripture give of heaven: a banquet, a city, a new earth?
- Would seeing God's face be boring?
- Is my picture of heaven from the Bible or from cartoons?
- What is the best moment of my life, and could heaven be better?
- What am I looking forward to most about being with God?

Truth summary

> Heaven will not be boring. No eye has seen what God has prepared for those who love Him. In His presence is fullness of joy and pleasures forever. God promises a new heaven and earth, a great feast, and the joy of seeing His face. The best things here are only a shadow of what is coming.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Heaven
- Eternal Life
- Joy
- Worship
- Praise Him

Listen: Overcoming Depression

Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

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HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "Heaven will be an endless, boring church service"

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Read through each section and **check the one that fits you best**. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ **Date started:** _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"Heaven will be an endless, boring church service." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What has God prepared for those who love Him?
- ☐ What is in God's presence?
- ☐ What pictures does Scripture give of heaven?
- ☐ Would seeing God's face be boring?
- ☐ Is my picture from the Bible or cartoons?
- ☐ What do I look forward to most?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ No eye has seen what God has prepared for me.
- ☐ In God's presence is fullness of joy.
- ☐ God will make a new heaven and a new earth.
- ☐ I will share a great banquet in God's kingdom.
- ☐ I will see God's face.
- ☐ Every good thing here is a shadow of what is coming.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- [ ] **1 Corinthians 2:9**
  "Rather, as it is written: 'No eye has seen, no ear has heard, no heart has imagined, what God has prepared for those who love Him.'"

- [ ] **Psalm 16:11**
  "You have made known to me the path of life; You will fill me with joy in Your presence, with eternal pleasures at Your right hand."

- [ ] **Revelation 21:1–3**
  "Then I saw a new heaven and a new earth, for the first heaven and earth had passed away, and the sea was no more. I saw the holy city, the new Jerusalem, coming down out of heaven from God, prepared as a bride adorned for her husband. And I heard a loud voice from the throne saying: 'Behold, the dwelling place of God is with man, and He will dwell with them. They will be His people, and God Himself will be with them as their God.'"

- [ ] **Matthew 8:11**
  "I say to you that many will come from the east and the west to share the banquet with Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob in the kingdom of heaven."

- [ ] **Revelation 22:3–5**
  "No longer will there be any curse. The throne of God and of the Lamb will be within the city, and His servants will worship Him. They will see His face, and His name will be on their foreheads. There will be no more night in the city, and they will have no need for the light of a lamp or of the sun. For the Lord God will shine on them, and they will reign forever and ever."

A verse I found myself: _____

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HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first three. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- ☐ **Make my Truth Card** (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- ☐ **Memorize my Scripture** from Step 4.
- ☐ **Set reminders** to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ **A buzz:** my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ **An everyday event:** every time I _____
  - ☐ **A visual reminder:** something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ **Foretaste log:** Each day, write one good moment that gave me a small taste of heaven's joy.
- ☐ **My name in Scripture:** Rewrite my verse with my name in it and read it aloud each morning.
  *For example, Psalm 16:11 becomes: "You have made known to **Sarah** the path of life; You will fill **her** with joy in Your presence, with eternal pleasures at Your right hand."*
- ☐ **Gratitude journal:** Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ **Truth recording:** Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- ☐ **Reading:** The "Heaven" topic in Pearls.
- ☐ **Listening:** The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

- ☐ **Read Revelation 21 and 22,** and write down five things that surprise you about heaven.
- ☐ **Write a list of your favorite earthly joys,** and thank God that heaven will be even better.
- ☐ **Ask a mature believer** what they look forward to most about heaven.
- ☐ **Read a good Christian book about heaven** for fifteen minutes this week.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

What I learned: _____

The lie "Heaven will be an endless, boring church service": _____ % **My truth:** _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	One foretaste of heaven's joy
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~Heaven will be an endless, boring church service.~~

THE TRUTH

_____

_____

GOD'S WORD

_____

_____

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Father, thank You that You have prepared more than I can imagine for those who love You. Help me reject the lie that heaven will be an endless, boring church service. Stir my heart with joy as I think about seeing Your face, and let the good things of this life point me to You. In Jesus' name, Amen.

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Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.